Unsafe Returned Products: Quarantine and No-Resale Guideline

ShopSphere Retail - electrical and thermal safety

Guideline ID	RFB-SAF-2025-02
Version	1.1
Effective date	2025-05-15
Applies to	Any unit with inspection condition = unsafe
Permitted recovery methods	recycle, dispose ONLY

1. Rule

A unit classified as unsafe must never be resold, sold as open-box, repaired for resale, refurbished for resale, or returned to stock. The only permitted recovery methods are recycle and dispose. Any recovery option of another type for an unsafe unit must be marked not_feasible.

2. What counts as unsafe

- Thermal damage: scorch marks, melted plastic, burning odour.
- Electrical: failed insulation resistance or earth continuity test, exposed live parts.
- Battery: swelling, leakage, or venting.
- Mechanical: sharp edges or broken guards around moving parts.

3. Quarantine procedure

- Stop testing once unsafe is confirmed. Do not power the unit again.
- Bag the unit in a fire-safe bag, tag it QUARANTINE - DO NOT RESELL, and move it to the hazardous-goods cage.
- Open an investigation case of type safety_concern and notify the Product Safety Lead the same day.
- Raise a supplier defect report so the supplier can contain the affected lots.

4. Worked example

Return R115 (HomeHive Air Purifier 300, serial HA9933, order O115): inspection IR-2026-00015 found scorch marks and melted plastic at the power inlet, and a failed insulation resistance test. The unit is unsafe. No resale is permitted. Disposition: recycle through an authorised e-waste recycler, or dispose if the recycler refuses thermally damaged units.

5. Customer resolution

The customer's refund or replacement is handled separately under the category return policy and its approval thresholds. The safety disposition of the unit does not reduce the customer's entitlement.